

Night Ops Packing Checklist

Blue hour punishes the unprepared and rewards the packed. Run this list before every night op — the goal is to arrive with everything and think about nothing but the light.

CAMERA

- ☐ **Body + charged battery**
battery in the camera, not the charger
- ☐ **Wide lens, hood on**
blue hour lives at 16–35mm; hood kills the flare from streetlights
- ☐ **Caps off the plan, not the bag**
rear cap in a pocket — fumbling caps in the dark is how glass gets dropped

SEE & CLEAN

- ☐ **Headlamp with red mode**
white light kills your night vision and everyone's composition
- ☐ **Microfiber + blower**
dew forms on front elements as the air cools
- ☐ **Rain cover / plastic bag**
dew is rain that arrives politely

SUPPORT

- ☐ **Tripod + head, rated for your rig**
if it creeps at 4 seconds, it stays home
- ☐ **Remote release** — or 2-sec timer pre-set
your finger is an earthquake at slow shutters
- ☐ **Stabilization: know the switch**
OFF on the tripod — find it by feel before you leave

OPERATOR

- ☐ **Exposure Ladder cheat sheet**
printed, or on the phone — then the phone goes away
- ☐ **Warm layer + dial-friendly gloves**
shivering hands can't feel a focus ring
- ☐ **Small towel**
for the tripod legs, the bag, the bench you sit on

POWER & MEDIA

- ☐ **2× spare batteries**
cold drains them fast; keep one in a warm pocket
- ☐ **Formatted cards + 1 spare**
format in-camera the night before, never on-site

BEFORE YOU LEAVE — 60 SECONDS

Scouted in daylight? Tripod marks set? **Batteries charged?** Cards formatted? **WB preset** noted (4000K / 3200K)? **Exit time** planned? If any answer is no, you are not ready — and blue hour will know.